

TRA-VAUGHN JAMES

tmcbjames@gmail.com | [Portfolio](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, Heinz College, Pittsburgh, PA
Master of Science in Information Security Policy & Management

August 2023 - May 2025

Earlham College, Richmond, IN
Bachelor of Arts, Computer Science

May 2023

- Honors Program & McNair Scholar | Networked with Earlham alumni and industry professionals at various events

SKILLS & COURSEWORK

Tools: Ansible, Linux/Unix, EC2, S3, Wireshark, Snort, Kibana, Sguil, Nmap, Burp Suite, PfSense, Metasploit, Security Onion

Coursework: Network Defenses, Ethical Penetration Testing, Software and Security, Malicious Code Analysis, Applied Information Assurance

Programming Languages: Python, C, Bash, SQL, Java, Swift, PowerShell, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, React

Databases: Oracle SQL, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Supabase

Certifications: CompTIA Security+

PROFESSIONAL/ACADEMIC PROJECTS

AI Red Teaming | HackTheBox

- Acquired AI Red Teaming skills in HTB, including techniques like Prompt Engineering, Sparsity Attacks, and AI Evasion

Web Goat Penetration Testing | Software and Security

- Identified and Exploited Web Application Vulnerabilities in the Web Goat App using ZAP, Burp Suite, and Nessus

SOAR Automation | Personal Project

- Utilized Shuffle SOAR and TheHive to automate Wazuh incident response and security orchestration.

Cyber Risk Assessment AI Agent | Information Security Capstone

- Project Manager of a team of 5 developed a Voice-Based AI Agent capable of conducting cyber risk assessments.

AI Christian IOS Application | Production Product

- Published an iOS AI-powered Bible Study application utilizing Swift, Supabase, and Gemini API, now live [here](#)

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

MSA The Safety Company, Cranberry Twp, PA
Cybersecurity Intern

May 2024 - August 2024

- Established an Open Source Threat Intelligence Server, ensuring reliable detection of network security and host-based threats, saving \$50,000 per year on commercial threat feeds
- Orchestrated data via API's from SIEM, Firewall, and Threat Intel to be ingested into an analytics engine
- Designed PowerShell and Python scripts to automate CLI and log analysis workflows, reducing average time by 70%
- Simulated DOS and covert network scanning attacks against Firewalls to tune alarms and develop detection rules
- Architected a Beats server to improve log aggregation, augmenting the SIEM for more refined security analytics

Paulsen Coaching, Remote
Sales Development Representative

June 2023 - August 2023

- Curated Sales, Negotiation, and verbal communication skills through B2B Cold Calling and customer interaction

Earlham College, Richmond, IN
System Administrator

August 2020 - January 2023

- Developed 2 new servers and 1 new cluster, improving the efficiency of Biology and ML research, decreasing the average time of workflows by 40%.
- Triaged and troubleshooted server, cluster, and user issues, maintaining an uptime of core services of at least 99%
- Created a Xen Virtual Sandbox for administrators to test installations/patches, decreasing server outages by 30%.
- Mended and maintained 8 public desktops, implementing least privilege controls via IAM, firewall, and LDAP policies

Carnegie Mellon University-Heinz, Pittsburgh, PA
IT Lab SSI Fellow

Summer 2022

- Led a cross-functional team of three along with USSTRATCOM personnel on research on Deterrence Theory; documenting findings in a research paper and presenting to USSTRATCOM officials and CMU faculty
- Applied knowledge of cloud security fundamentals by undergoing AWS Certified Cloud Foundation course and labs.